

Merve Sahiner

Interior Designer / Architect

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Location: Turkey

EDUCATION

- Eastern Mediterranean University (EMU)** Famagusta, Cyprus
Bachelor of Interior Architecture (CIDA Accredited Program) 2017-2023
- Karatay University (KTO)** Konya, Turkey
Master of Architecture 2025-2027

SKILLS SUMMARY

- Interior Design Scope:** Concept Development, Space Planning, High-End Residential Interiors, Kitchen & Bath Design, Material/Finish Selection, Decorative Lighting Selection, Interior Detailing, Styling & Final Install Coordination
- FF&E & Procurement:** FF&E Selection & Specifications, Finish & FF&E Schedules, Budget Tracking, Vendor/Showroom Coordination, Lead-Time Management, Purchase Support, Delivery/Installation Coordination, Punch List Support
- Technical Documentation & BIM:** AutoCAD (Plans/Elevations/Details), Revit, ArchiCAD, Detailed Elevations, Joinery/Millwork & Casework Drawings, Lighting Plans, Finish Plans
- Visualization & Presentation:** SketchUp, 3ds Max, Corona Renderer, Lumion, Adobe Photoshop; 3D Modeling, Photorealistic Rendering, Material Visualization, Client-Facing Presentations
- Social Media & Digital Content:** Social Media Management, Content Planning, Visual Content Creation, Brand-Aware Content, Digital Presentation & Communication
- Professional Strengths:** Client Communication & Expectation Management, Strong Aesthetic Judgment, Detail-Oriented Approach, Time Planning & Deadline Management, Problem Solving, Team Collaboration, High Ownership & Reliability
- Languages:** Turkish (Native), English (Fluent)

EXPERIENCE

- Luzione** San Francisco/CA
Interior designer (Contract-Remote) Feb 2026 – Present
 - Design Systems & Finish Packages:** Led full-room concepts and cohesive product/finish palettes for residential and hospitality projects.
 - Specification & Collections:** Defined designer-friendly collections and specification logic aligned with US studio workflows.
 - Sales/Spec Collateral:** Created clear spec sheets and presentation assets to improve product clarity and client decision-making.
 - Team & Stakeholder Alignment:** Mentored junior designers and aligned scope, timelines, and deliverables across stakeholders.
- Aksiyal Architecture** Konya, TR
Interior Designer May 2024 – Jan 2026
 - Multi-Villa Delivery:** Delivered interior design and site coordination for a 16-villa residential development.
 - Production Drawings:** Produced coordinated drawing sets (plans/elevations/sections/details) with buildable documentation standards.
 - QA/QC & Redlines:** Managed revisions, redlines, and on-site feedback loops to keep drawings consistent and executable.
 - Materials & Presentations:** Supported layouts, materials/finishes, and presentation outputs across apartment and residential projects.
- Kurtsan Group** Famagusta, CY
Interior Architect (Real Estate Development) Feb 2023 – Mar 2024
 - Concept to Documentation:** Supported residential interiors from early concept through detailed documentation and updates.
 - Finish Plans & Selections:** Prepared finish plans and material/FF&E selections balancing design intent, cost, and schedule.
 - Detailing & Coordination:** Developed technical details and coordinated drawing changes with contractors and consultants.
 - Spec/Procurement Support:** Contributed to specification decisions to improve build feasibility and execution consistency.
- Maisons CBI** Rennes, FR
Intern Interior Architect Jun 2021 – Aug 2021
 - Layout Studies:** Assisted with layout options and early-stage spatial planning for residential projects.
 - Materials & Boards:** Prepared material boards and finish selections for client presentations.
 - Presentation Support:** Supported presentation decks and visual storytelling for design proposals.
 - Drafting & Visualization:** Helped with drafting and basic 3D/visualization tasks for ongoing project work.

PROJECTS

- **Gocek Luxury Villa (Residential Interior):** Full-scope interior design from concept to documentation: space planning, material & finish selection, FF&E coordination, lighting approach, and presentation-ready visuals. Tech: AutoCAD, SketchUp, Enscape, InDesign (2026)
- **Twin Villa Design (Luxury Residential):** Led villa interior concept development and visualization; defined cohesive palettes and detailing direction for timeless, high-end residential design. Tech: AutoCAD, 3ds Max, Corona Renderer, Lumion (2024)
- **Penthouse Design (Residential):** Space planning, material/finish selection, and 3D visualization focused on maximizing daylight and sea views with warm contemporary finishes. Tech: AutoCAD, SketchUp, Lumion (2023)
- **Office Design (Commercial Interior):** Open-plan office layout + documentation support: drawings, BIM/model coordination, client decks, and visualizations; refined atmosphere using warm woods and glass partitions. Tech: ArchiCAD, SketchUp, Enscape (2024)
- **Selected Kitchen Designs (K&B):** Kitchen planning and visualization studies across multiple styles; focused on workflow, proportions, cabinetry detailing, realistic materials, and lighting decisions. Tech: AutoCAD, 3ds Max, Corona, SketchUp, Photoshop (2023–2026)
- **Urban Furniture Design — 2nd Prize (Competition):** Designed a modular circular urban seating concept for the historic Walled City context; awarded 2nd Prize for form innovation and sustainable approach. Tech: AutoCAD, SketchUp, Photoshop (2021)

RESEARCH & ACADEMIC WORK

- **Thesis Research (M.Sc. Architecture) — Sustainable Facade Materials:** Ongoing research on sustainable facade materials and environmental performance (bio-composites, locally sourced materials). Academic publication planned for 2027.
- **Hybrid House (EMU Project Archive) — 2nd Year, 4th Semester Studio:** Archived in Feb 2021 for strong concept and plan organization. Designed for two dancers: ground floor integrates living + work/studio needs; upper floor is private bedrooms. Developed as a practical and aesthetic response to pandemic-era work-from-home living.

HONORS AND AWARDS

- 2nd Prize — Urban Furniture Design Competition (Cyprus Municipality) – 2021
- High Honor Certificate — Eastern Mediterranean University – 2022
- Certificate — Architectural Board & Presentation Design (Adobe Photoshop)

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

- **Volunteer — LOSEV (Cyprus & Turkey)** Cyprus & Turkey
Volunteer Support & Community Work 2018 – 2023
 - **Community Support:** Supported volunteer initiatives and event-based community work for families and children.
- **Volunteer — AFAD (Hatay Earthquake Response)** Hatay, Turkey
Disaster Relief Volunteer 2023
 - **Field Support:** Assisted relief operations and on-ground coordination during the post-earthquake response.
- **Volunteer — AIESEC Project (Orphanage Program)** Targu Mures, Romania
Youth Support Volunteer 2018 (5 weeks)
 - **Youth Development:** Supported activities helping children discover strengths and develop skills through structured sessions.